ARTIST PROTOCOL

Cover-up & Rework

Plan from before photos. Times in [brackets] are guides. Check your state and local health department rules.

SCREEN

Intake, ID and cover-up consent signed. Old tattoo fully healed. Original artist noted.

ASSESS OLD WORK

Darkness, saturation, scarring and size. Too dark? Refer for laser fading first.

SET EXPECTATIONS

New design larger or darker. Old ink may show through. [2+] sessions likely.

SET UP FIRST ☐ Before photos taken ☐ Barrier film on machine, cord, chair ☐ Nitrile gloves ☐ Sealed single-use cartridges ☐ Ink caps poured per client ☐ Sharps container ☐ Ink lot # noted

#	STEP	TIME	HOW
1	**Screen & photos**	15 min	Review intake and ID. Photograph the old tattoo from 2 angles in good light.
2	**Set up station**	10 min	Disinfect, barrier film on. Open cartridges in front of the client.
3	**Skin prep**	5 min	Shave with a single-use razor, then antiseptic. Note scars and raised lines.
4	**Stencil & approval**	15 min	Map old dark areas under the new design. Client approves in a mirror.
5	**Lining**	[ ] min	Line over old work only where planned. Don't trace old lines that will show.
6	**Packing & shading**	[ ] min	Saturate dark zones fully. Go gently over scar tissue; don't overwork.
7	**Wipe-down & check**	5 min	Check old lines are hidden where planned. After photos for the record.
8	**Wrap**	5 min	Thin ointment, wrap or film as agreed. Heavy fill weeps more.
9	**Aftercare review**	5 min	Heavy saturation may heal slower. Next session in [3–4] weeks.
10	**Breakdown**	10 min	Cartridges and razor to sharps; caps, film, towels to waste. Disinfect.
11	**Record**	5 min	Log inks, lots, photos and what is left to cover. Book the next session.

ENDPOINT AND SAFETY

- Old tattoo hidden where planned; no grey shadow
- Before and after photos saved with the record
- Solid saturation; scar tissue not overworked
- Nothing reused; sharps never recapped

IF SOMETHING GOES WRONG

- Fainting or dizziness: stop, recline the client with legs raised. Water and sugar; resume only if fully well.
- Allergic reaction (hives, swelling): stop, remove the wrap. Breathing trouble or face swelling: call 911.
- Scar tissue or old ink won't take: stop on that area. Let it heal and reassess.
- Excessive bleeding: stop, firm pressure with clean gauze. Pause or reschedule; recheck blood thinners.
- Needle-stick: wash with soap and water, report it to the studio owner, follow your OSHA exposure plan.
- Raised old lines or keloid signs: stop, photograph, refer to a doctor before more work.

Always write an incident report, note the ink lot and check in with the client within 24 to 48 hours.

RECORD FOR THIS SESSION

Ink brand · color · lot #	Ink expiry	Cartridges used	Machine · voltage
Old tattoo notes	**Session # of [ ]**	**Laser fading first?**	**Time · initials**